

MOCK LAB ROLE CARDS

Midwest Metal Fabricators (MMF)

Custom Metal Fabrication | 85 Employees | 3 Locations

Each team member has a role card with:

- How to fill out the survey
- How to behave during discovery
- What to advocate for during POC selection
- How to act during the close

Facilitator: SA team

JON

Playing: Jon, CEO/Owner

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You took over the business from your dad 8 years ago. You know AI is important but you're not sure where to start. You've been burned by technology projects before — the ERP implementation 2 years ago was painful. You're optimistic but cautious. Your uncle (the best estimator) is retiring in 18 months and you're worried about losing his knowledge.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	7	<i>We've got decent systems, ERP is finally stable</i>
Data Maturity	5	<i>Data's there somewhere, not sure it's organized</i>
Technical Skills	5	<i>Colin knows tech, rest of us are learning</i>
Budget/Resources	6	<i>We can find money for the right project</i>
Leadership Support	8	<i>I'm bought in, I'll make this happen</i>
Strategic Alignment	5	<i>We want to do this, still figuring out what exactly</i>
Change Management	5	<i>We're ready to move fast (you're overestimating this)</i>
AI Culture	6	<i>People are curious, some skeptics on the floor</i>

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- We're ready to move fast on this
- Our best estimator (my uncle) is retiring in 18 months — need to capture his knowledge
- Lost some deals recently due to slow quoting

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Tribal knowledge capture (you care about this emotionally)
- Quoting speed
- Making better decisions faster

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- Give SURFACE-LEVEL answers until pushed 2-3 times
- First answer: "Quoting takes too long"
- If pushed: "We lost a few deals"
- If pushed harder: "Three deals last month, one was \$180K"
- Mention the ERP disaster if asked about past tech projects

DURING POC SELECTION

- Advocate strongly for TRIBAL KNOWLEDGE CAPTURE
- This is emotional for you — it's your uncle's knowledge
- Push back if others want quoting: "But what happens when Uncle Ray retires?"

DURING THE CLOSE

When asked for a Monday action, say "I'll think about it and get back to you." Make the facilitator push you. Only commit if they ask 2-3 times and get specific.

Mike

Playing: Mike, Operations Manager

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You run the shop floor. You know where everything actually breaks. You're skeptical of technology promises because you've seen initiatives come and go. You'll be honest but you won't volunteer information — people have to ask you directly. You spend 2-3 hours a day answering "where's my job" questions and it's killing your productivity.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	5	ERP is okay, shop floor systems are dated
Data Maturity	3	Data's scattered everywhere, nothing talks to anything
Technical Skills	4	Office has skills, floor doesn't
Budget/Resources	4	Money goes to machines, not software
Leadership Support	6	Jon talks about it, not sure he'll push through resistance
Strategic Alignment	3	Everyone wants different things
Change Management	2	We roll stuff out and people ignore it
AI Culture	4	Floor guys are skeptical, think AI will replace them

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- We've tried new systems before. Adoption is always the problem.
- I spend 2-3 hours a day answering 'where's my job' questions
- Our people are good at their jobs but resistant to change

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Job tracking / status visibility
- Knowing where things are without having to ask
- Scheduling and capacity planning

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- DON'T VOLUNTEER INFORMATION — wait to be asked directly
- Stay quiet unless someone asks you specifically
- When asked about job tracking, reveal the 2-3 hours/day stat
- Be the voice of "our people won't use this"
- If asked about past tech rollouts, describe failures matter-of-factly

DURING POC SELECTION

- STAY QUIET unless directly asked
- If asked: reveal that job tracking is actually YOUR #1 pain
- Be skeptical of both tribal knowledge and quoting: "Who's going to maintain it?"

DURING THE CLOSE

You WILL commit if directly asked, but don't volunteer. Wait for the facilitator to call on you specifically. Then give a realistic, practical Monday action.

VINNY

Playing: Vinny, VP Sales

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You're drowning in quote requests. You know quoting is a mess but you're too busy to fix it. You're enthusiastic about AI because you're desperate for help. You tend to jump to solutions before fully defining problems. You already use ChatGPT for customer emails. The quote spreadsheet is a disaster — every estimator does it differently.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	6	<i>We've got what we need, mostly</i>
Data Maturity	4	<i>Quote history is a mess, everyone does it differently</i>
Technical Skills	5	<i>I can figure stuff out, team varies</i>
Budget/Resources	5	<i>If it helps sales, Jon will fund it</i>
Leadership Support	7	<i>Jon wants us to win more deals</i>
Strategic Alignment	4	<i>Not sure what we're prioritizing</i>
Change Management	4	<i>Sales team will adopt if it helps them</i>
AI Culture	6	<i>I use ChatGPT already, others are curious</i>

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- Quoting takes way too long, we're losing deals
- I already use ChatGPT to help draft customer emails
- Our quote spreadsheet is a disaster — everyone does it differently

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Quote automation / faster estimates
- Customer communication
- Proposal generation

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- Be ENTHUSIASTIC but VAGUE: "AI could totally fix our quoting!"
- When asked for specifics, admit you don't know average quote turnaround time
- JUMP TO SOLUTIONS — make the facilitator slow you down
- Say things like "What if we just..." before the problem is fully defined
- If pressed on the spreadsheet mess, reveal that different estimators use completely different methods

DURING POC SELECTION

- Advocate strongly for QUOTING AUTOMATION
- This is your daily pain — you feel it constantly
- Be dismissive of tribal knowledge: "That's a nice-to-have, quoting is urgent"

DURING THE CLOSE

Commit IMMEDIATELY but VAGUELY — "Yeah, I'll start looking at this!" This is a shallow commitment. If the facilitator is good, they'll push you to be more specific.

ZUBIA

Playing: Zubia, Controller

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You control the money. You're skeptical of ROI claims because you've heard them before. You actually have data that could help (quote-to-close rates), but nobody ever asks you for it. You'll push on cost and measurable outcomes. You've seen technology investments fail to deliver returns.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	6	<i>Financial systems are solid, ops systems less so</i>
Data Maturity	5	<i>I have good data, not sure about other departments</i>
Technical Skills	5	<i>Accounting team is capable</i>
Budget/Resources	4	<i>We have budget but it's tight, need clear ROI</i>
Leadership Support	7	<i>Jon says he supports it</i>
Strategic Alignment	4	<i>Haven't agreed on priorities</i>
Change Management	3	<i>We announce things and hope people adopt</i>
AI Culture	5	<i>Mixed feelings, some curiosity, some fear</i>

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- Need to see clear ROI before committing budget
- I have quote-to-close rate data if anyone wants it
- We've invested in technology before without seeing returns

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Anything with measurable cost savings
- Financial forecasting
- I'd support quoting automation if we can prove the ROI

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- Ask about COST and ROI at least TWICE during discovery
- Be skeptical: "We've heard that before"
- When pushed, REVEAL: "I actually have quote-to-close rate data if anyone wants it"
- Don't volunteer this — wait until it's relevant and someone's struggling for numbers
- Question vague claims: "How would we measure that?"

DURING POC SELECTION

- Be SKEPTICAL of tribal knowledge capture: "How do you measure ROI on that?"
- Would support quoting IF ROI is clear
- Ask: "What does this cost and what do we get back?"

DURING THE CLOSE

Ask a CLARIFYING QUESTION that delays the close: "What exactly would we be committing to? What's the investment?" Make the facilitator work to get you to a Monday action.

Chris

Playing: Chris, IT Manager

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You're the technical person. You understand what's possible and what's hard. You're excited about AI but realistic about implementation challenges. You know the data is messier than leadership thinks — it's in 4 different systems that don't talk to each other. You've been experimenting with AI tools on your own.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	6	<i>Core systems are okay, integration is the challenge</i>
Data Maturity	3	<i>Data silos everywhere, inconsistent formats</i>
Technical Skills	6	<i>I can handle it, need to upskill others</i>
Budget/Resources	5	<i>IT budget is what it is</i>
Leadership Support	7	<i>Jon's supportive, doesn't always understand complexity</i>
Strategic Alignment	4	<i>Lots of ideas, no clear priority</i>
Change Management	3	<i>Tech rollouts have been rough historically</i>
AI Culture	5	<i>Interest varies widely by department</i>

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- Data integration will be the hard part
- We have good raw data but it's in 4 different systems that don't talk
- I've been experimenting with AI tools, seeing potential

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Data integration / single source of truth
- Internal knowledge base
- Automating IT support tickets

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- Be **REALISTIC** about implementation complexity
- When others get excited, mention data integration challenges
- But also show **GENUINE ENTHUSIASM** for what's possible
- If asked technical questions, give thoughtful, nuanced answers
- Reveal: data is in 4 systems (ERP, quote spreadsheets, email, shop floor tablets)

DURING POC SELECTION

- Think **QUOTING** is more technically feasible in 90 minutes than tribal knowledge
- Offer technical perspective: "Tribal knowledge capture is a 6-month project, quoting we could demo today"
- Be the voice of technical realism without being negative

DURING THE CLOSE

Give a **SPECIFIC, TECHNICAL** Monday action if asked — something like "I'll pull the quote data from the last 6 months and see what format it's in." Show you're engaged and practical.

Anna

Playing: Anna, Chief Marketing Officer

YOUR PERSPECTIVE

You're Tom's cousin — brought in 3 years ago to modernize the company's market presence. You've been pushing for better customer communication and brand positioning, but the company is still very operations-focused. You see AI as a way to finally get marketing taken seriously. You're frustrated that sales and ops get all the attention while marketing runs on spreadsheets and gut feel. You've used AI tools for content creation and see huge potential.

HOW TO FILL OUT THE SURVEY

Score each dimension as shown. The reasoning is your internal thinking — don't share it, just use it to stay in character.

Infrastructure	5	Marketing tools are separate from everything else
Data Maturity	4	We have customer data but can't connect it to sales outcomes
Technical Skills	5	My team is scrappy, we figure things out
Budget/Resources	4	Marketing budget is always first to get cut
Leadership Support	6	Tom listens but ops always wins priority
Strategic Alignment	3	No one agrees on what we're building toward
Change Management	4	Marketing adapts fast, rest of company doesn't
AI Culture	6	My team's excited, sales is curious, floor doesn't care

WRITTEN COMMENTS TO INCLUDE

- We have no idea which marketing efforts actually drive quotes
- Customer communication is inconsistent — sales says one thing, we say another
- I've been using ChatGPT for content and it's been a game-changer for my small team

USE CASES TO MENTION

- Marketing attribution — connecting campaigns to closed deals
- Customer communication consistency
- Content generation and personalization
- Competitive intelligence

DURING DISCOVERY — HOW TO BEHAVE

- Be ENGAGED and ARTICULATE — you've thought about this
- Push your own agenda: marketing attribution and customer communication
- Get slightly frustrated when ops dominates the conversation: "Can we talk about the customer side?"
- Reveal: you have NO visibility into which marketing efforts drive quotes
- If asked about current tools, admit it's mostly spreadsheets and MailChimp

DURING POC SELECTION

- Advocate for CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION or marketing attribution
- Feel like an outsider — quoting and tribal knowledge are ops/sales priorities
- Say something like: "These are all internal problems. What about the customer experience?"
- Will compromise if customer communication gets folded into quoting somehow

DURING THE CLOSE

Commit genuinely but with a MARKETING spin — "I'll map out all the customer touchpoints where we're inconsistent." You're engaged, you want this to work, but you want marketing to have a seat at the table.